



1306-09

GIOTTO REINVENTS ART

In the early 14th century, Italian artist Giotto di Bondone painted his masterwork, the frescoes that decorate the Arena (or Scrovegni) chapel in Padua. Illustrating the life of the Virgin Mary and of Christ, they displayed an emotional realism of gesture and expression that challenged the static Byzantine artistic tradition of the time. In retrospect, Giotto's work is seen as prefiguring the art of the Italian Renaissance.

“Let evil swiftly befall those who
have wrongly condemned us:
God will avenge us.”

TEMPLAR GRAND MASTER JACQUES DE MOLAY
BEFORE HIS EXECUTION, 1314

1300

1302 At the Battle of Courtrai, mounted French knights are slaughtered by Flemish foot soldiers

1309 In the Avignon papacy, Pope Clement V, controlled by France, resides in Avignon instead of Rome

1314 The Knights Templar are destroyed and their Grand Master Jacques de Molay is executed by Philip IV of France

1314
DANTE'S DIVINE COMEDY

A political exile driven out of his native city of Florence, Italian poet Dante Alighieri probably began work on his poetic masterpiece *The Divine Comedy* in 1314. His decision to write in Italian rather than Latin was a crucial break with medieval tradition. Comprising 14,233 lines of verse, the epic poem follows its narrator on a journey through Hell and Purgatory to Paradise.

Recognized as one of the greatest works in the Western literary tradition, it was completed a year before Dante's death in 1321.



▷ *Dante and the Three Kingdoms*, Domenico di Michelino, 1465